



Get free local bookings from Google

Your Google Business Profile — set-up & optimisation checklist

When someone near Longtown or Carlisle searches “**lash technician near me**” or “**eyelash extensions Cumbria**”, Google shows a map with 3 salons at the top. Those 3 get the bookings — **for free**, before anyone scrolls down. This guide gets Dolled by Louise into that top 3. It's the cheapest bookings you'll ever get: no ad budget, no commission. Work through it once, then spend 5 minutes a week keeping it active.

1 Claim & verify your profile

- Go to **google.com/business** and sign in with the Dolled by Louise Google account.
- Search for **Dolled by Louise** — if a profile already exists, claim it; if not, create it.
- Google verifies by **video, phone or postcard**. Do this first — nothing shows publicly until you're verified.

2 Fill in every single field

Google ranks complete profiles above half-finished ones. Leave nothing blank.

- **Business name:** Dolled by Louise — *exactly as it's known, no keyword stuffing (against Google's rules)*
- **Phone:** [add your salon mobile so clients can call/text to book]
- **Website:** <https://dolledbylouise.co.uk>
- **Address / service area:** set your Longtown studio address (or mark it a **service-area / home studio** if you'd rather keep the address private), then add a **service area** of Longtown, Carlisle, Brampton, Gretna & surrounding Cumbria.
- **Hours:** set your **real opening hours** accurately — Google flags “open now”, and wrong hours lose bookings and earn bad reviews.
- **Booking link:** add your booking system or WhatsApp link in the “**Bookings**” / appointment-link field so people can book straight from Google.

3 Pick the right categories

- **Primary category:** Eyelash service
- **Secondary categories:** Beauty salon Eyebrow bar

The primary category is one of the biggest ranking factors — get it exactly right.

4 Add real photos (this matters more than people think)

- Upload **15–20 real photos** — close-ups of fresh lash sets, before/after, lash lifts, the studio, and you at work.
- Add your **logo** and a **cover photo**.
- Add a few fresh photos **every week or two** — active profiles rank higher and look trustworthy.

Beauty is visual — clients book the lashes they can see. You already have a gorgeous gallery on the website; reuse those shots here.

5 Write a keyword-rich description & services

- In the **description**, naturally mention: *classic, hybrid & Russian volume lash extensions, infills, lash lifts & tints, brow treatments, the Lash Club, Longtown & Carlisle, Cumbria.*
- Add each treatment as a separate **Service** with a short sentence and price — they show on your profile and help you appear for those searches.

6 Reviews — the #1 ranking factor

More reviews = higher ranking *and* more bookings. Make asking part of every appointment.

How to do it the easy way

- In your profile, copy your “**review link**” (Google gives you a short link).
- Text it to the client the moment they leave, while they're loving their new lashes.
- **Reply to every review** — even a one-line thank-you. Google rewards it.

Copy-paste text to send clients:

“Thank you so much for coming in today — your lashes look gorgeous! 💕 If you’ve got 30 seconds, a quick Google review really helps my little business. Here’s the link: [your review link]. See you at your infill! Louise x”

Target: aim for your first **10 reviews** fast, then a steady trickle. Even 15–20 strong reviews puts you ahead of most local lash techs.

7 Post updates (like a free mini-Instagram)

- Use **Google Posts** to share a recent set, a last-minute cancellation slot, a seasonal offer (“Christmas lash sets booking now”), or a Lash Club reminder.
- One post a week keeps the profile active — Google favours active profiles.

8 Turn on messaging & answer questions

- Enable **messaging** so clients can text you straight from Google to book.
- Seed the **Q&A** section yourself: “How long do lash extensions last?” → “2–3 weeks before an infill. I’ll talk you through aftercare at your appointment.”

Your 5-minute weekly routine

- **Ask** every client that week for a Google review (send the text).
- **Reply** to any new reviews.
- **Add** 1–2 fresh lash photos.
- **Post** one update (a new set, an offer, or an open slot).
- **Check** your “insights” — how many people called, messaged or asked directions.

Do this and within a few weeks you'll be getting bookings from Google you didn't pay a penny for — on top of the website and Instagram.